

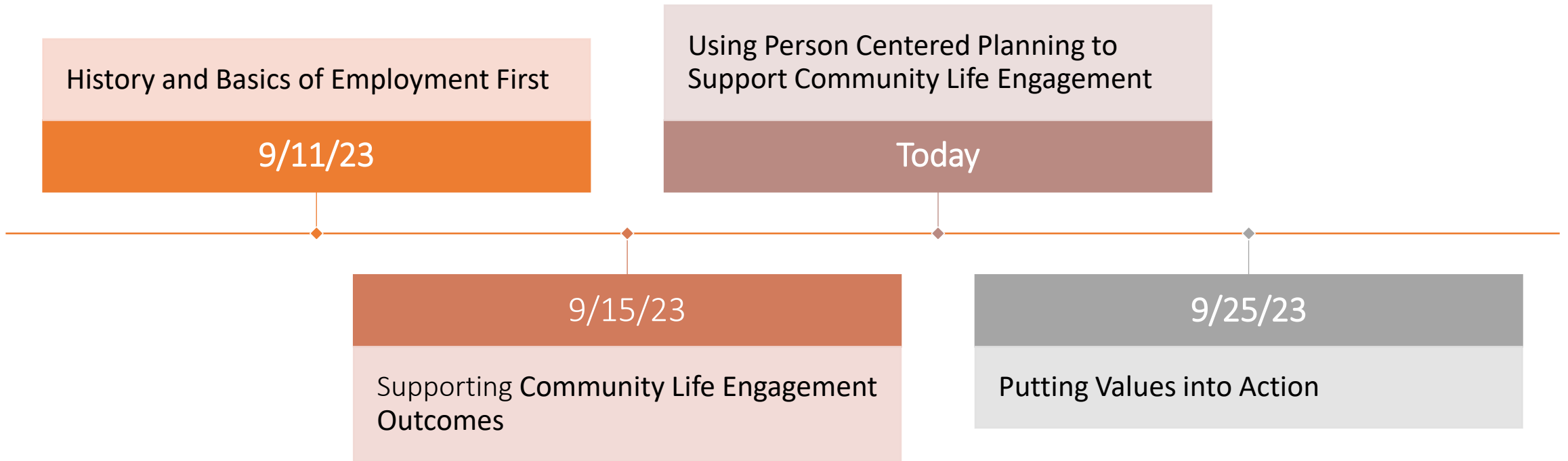
*MTI HOPE HAVEN
TRAINING SERIES:
PART III*

*PERSON CENTERED
PLANNING
AND COMMUNITY
LIFE ENGAGEMENT
OUTCOMES*



- Staci Jones, ICI Umass
- Don Lavin, Strengths at Work, LLC
- 9/18/23

Training Series Schedule



Quick Recap

Part I & II

Employment is Everyone's Job

We can, and should, support people wherever they are on their path to employment, ***no matter what service the person receives***



- **Adopting** Employment First values as an organization
- **Expecting** an employment as an outcome for people of working age
- **Keeping** employment exploration at the forefront
- **Supporting** community life engagement outcomes (***instead of “outings”***)



Community Life Engagement (CLE)

All the ways that people with I/DD access and participate in their communities, outside of employment, as part of a meaningful day.

- Not a program, these are **outcomes**
- Non-work
- Accessing typical community facilities (library, faith community, gym, rec center, etc.)
- Volunteerism
- Post-secondary &/or continuing education
- Wrap-around to work
- Retirement activities
- **A Pathway to work for people of working age...**



CLE Guideposts of Support

1

Individualize
supports for
each
person.



2

Promote
community
membership
and
contribution.



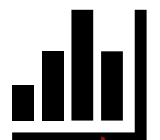
3

Build skills
and facilitate
relationships
to decrease
reliance on
paid staff.



4

Ensure that
supports are
outcome-
oriented and
monitored.





Person Centered Thinking & Planning



Tools and Strategies

Person-Centered Thinking

Set of principles and approaches that prioritize a person's unique interests and needs that emphasize:

- self determination
- discovering what is important to people
- informed choice
- flexibility
- dignity and respect
- leading to better outcomes and quality of life



[Person Centered Planning Principles - National Environmental Scan \(acl.gov\)](https://www.acl.gov/person-centered-planning-principles)

Person-Centered Planning

- An evidence-based practice
- A flexible set of approaches, tools and principles used for life planning
- Strength based vs deficit based
- With people not FOR people
- Originally developed to support people leaving institutions
- Conflict-free case management:
 - A person that does not have a direct or indirect interest in the person's choices of services/provider



[The Pioneers of Person Centred Planning - YouTube](#)

[Person Centered Planning Principles - National Environmental Scan \(acl.gov\)](#)

Person-Centered Planning in MN

"Formal person-centered planning will seek to:

- Understand who a person is
- Establish and support a personal vision
- Work to build community supports and actions on behalf of a person in achieving that vision"



[Home and Community Based Waivers/Alternative Care Program 101-Building a Strong Foundation of Knowledge \(state.mn.us\)](https://state.mn.us)

[Frequently asked questions about formal person-centered planning / Minnesota Department of Human Services \(mn.gov\)](https://mn.gov)

Person Centered Thinking
and learning *about* people
must be baked into service
delivery & the culture

MTI CLE CoP: Culture



Discovery

- Identifies ideal conditions of employment
- No one can 'fail' [Discovery](#)
- Completed by someone trained in Discovery
- Full engagement with the person and support team
- Assumes everyone can work
- Job Development immediately follows Discovery

How could Discovery support your Day Services?

How might you partner with Employment staff?

How could Discovery support people who are underemployed?

Small (d) discovery/exploration

- Can be used when Discovery is not available yet
- [Can be done in small, intentional groups](#)
- May be led by the person's interests
- Happens in typical community settings
- Get new experiences
- Build new connections
- Learn new skills (example: get lost on purpose)
- ***Fold the information we learn back into the service delivery***



Person Centered Profiles

What's
YOUR current
process?

How is info best learned and collected?

- One-on-one interviews with the person
 - What might we miss if we ONLY do this?)
- Observe the person in various community-based settings/activities
 - Don't make assumptions based on center-based history
- Interview people that know the person well
- Interview people the person trusts
- Observe at home (when possible/practical)
- File review and Individual Support Plan:
 - What might be here? What might not be?

[Microsoft Word - Developing a Positive Personal Profile G Tilson.docx \(dc.gov\)](#)

What ELSE are you paying attention to?

Everything!! (behavior is communication)

- Setting/environment
- Time of year
- Who else is around (??)
- Relationships
- Interests
- Mood
- Health
- Weather
- What else?



[10 Things: David Pitonyak](#)

Example of feedback loop or quality cycle

Services are dynamic, responsive and evolving based on new information and data



Language Matters



Use positive and person first language (not program language)



Be specific and clear



Be thorough



Focus on HOW and WHY to support people



Focus on outcomes (employment and community life engagement)



Update with new info



Language Matters

Example in positive profile:

John has behaviors when things don't go his way.

- What do you think about John when you read this?
 - What don't you know?

Language Matters

Example: *John has behaviors when things don't go his way.*

Vs.

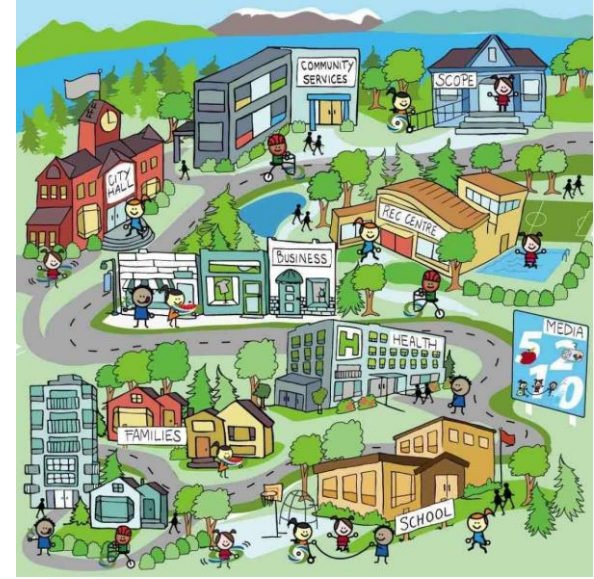
In order for John to be successfully supported to participate regularly in work and community activities, it is important that he participate in the development of his schedule ahead of time and be made aware of changes as soon as possible.

A schedule should be planned with John weekly by showing him pictures of what activities he may be interested in and helping him to choose which he prefers. Once the schedule is established, a copy of the picture schedule should be printed and provided to him so he can refer to it regularly.

If there needs to be a change in schedule, this should be shared with John as soon as possible, along with an updated picture schedule. This allows time for John to process and express his concerns about the changes. John likes to talk to his family on the phone in the evenings and them knowing John's schedule allows additional opportunity for the schedule to be reinforced with John. If changes are made, let them know as well, so they can support these changes.

Are you mapping your community?

- Create a map of community assets and resources within a defined area
- Highlight people, places, organizations, and institutions
- Walk and/drive around (don't just google...why not?)



Be curious!!!

- Don't know what goes on there and why? Find out!

[Mapping Relationships – LifeCourse Nexus \(lifecoursetools.com\)](https://lifecoursetools.com)

Are you mapping your community?

- Who is doing this? Do they know how? Do they have time?
- Where/how is info housed?
- Who uses the info and how? Who updates it?
- BOD, staff networks, families, employers can help broaden your scope

Example Spreadsheet

Name of business, organization or community location	Address	Type of business, organization or community location	Days/hours open to the public	Why do people go here? What do they do?	Important things to know about this local?	Contact person(s)	Other important info?

[Mapping Relationships – LifeCourse Nexus \(lifecoursetools.com\)](https://lifecoursetools.com)

How do we use the information? Work WITH the person to:

- Develop schedules of support
- Identify support needs
- Identify appropriate matching
- Identify desired/needed goals and skills
- Identify ideas for jobs, volunteerism, social roles, experiences, community membership and relationships
- Identify gaps
- Explore possibilities
- Notice contradictions
- Continually update

Connecting the dots

Group Exercise:

- Considering an existing individual profile: What do you know and what don't you know (if anything) that will help with person-centered planning in day services?
- How will you get this information? What tools, methods, strategies, or processes will you use?
- Based on what you DO know, what activities might lead to person-centered, community life engagement outcomes?
- Do you know where these type of activities take place?
- What skills would this person benefit from learning?
- What type of supports might the person need?
- How will you will explore the possibility of natural supports to enhance membership & inclusion?

Things to pay attention to:

- Skills that exist/skills needed
- Relationships
- Paid and unpaid work experiences
- Past community experiences
- Technology
- Support needs
- Ideal conditions
- Possibilities for jobs and community membership

What else?

Examples of Person-Centered Planning Tools

[Person Centered – LifeCourse Nexus \(lifecoursetools.com\)](https://lifecoursetools.com)

[Daily Life and Employment – LifeCourse Nexus \(lifecoursetools.com\)](https://lifecoursetools.com)

[One Page Profiles- Examples](#)

[Tools for Inclusion: Starting with Me: A Guide to Person-Centered Planning for Job Seekers \(umb.edu\)](https://umb.edu)

[Person-Centered Planning Tools - CLE-Toolkit \(communityinclusion.org\)](https://communityinclusion.org)

[Positive-Personal-Profile-Example.pdf \(transcen.org\)](https://transcen.org)

[Positive personal profile blank.pdf \(thinkcollege.net\)](https://thinkcollege.net)

[PositivePersonalProfile Transcen.pdf \(employmentfirstma.org\)](https://employmentfirstma.org)